

Martin Luther

The man who **SPLIT** the church in two

Martin Luther was a German priest who challenged the Catholic Church.

Struck by God

Martin Luther was born in 1483 in Eisleben, Germany. His parents wanted him to be a lawyer, so he studied law at university. One day he was almost **struck by lightning** during a storm. He thought that the close call was a **SIGN FROM GOD** that he should leave law, and he joined a monastery.



Forgiveness for sale

Luther soon realized that the Catholic Church was pretty corrupt. Priests were selling "**INDULGENCES**," which were a sort of "get-out-of-jail-free" card for sinners to get into heaven. In 1517, Luther wrote a list of complaints relating to the Catholic Church, which he called his **95 Theses**. His **ideas spread** around Europe very quickly.

Luther nailed his 95 Theses to the door of the church in Wittenberg, Germany.

He couldn't have done it without...

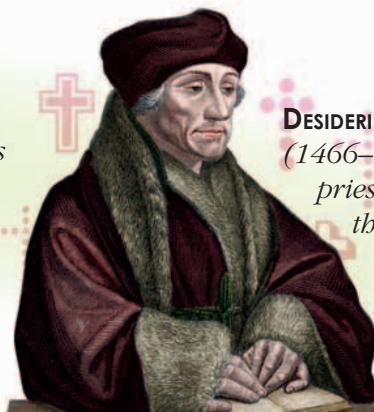


In 1440, the **PRINTING PRESS** made it possible for Luther's ideas to reach a lot of people very quickly.



Summoned by the Pope

Pope Leo X didn't take kindly to Luther's meddling, so he summoned Luther to the "**DIET OF WORMS**"—a Diet was a sort of meeting, and Worms was the town it was held in (no worms were eaten!) In 1521, Luther was declared an **outlaw** and heretic.



DESIDERIUS ERASMUS ROTERODAMUS (1466–1536) was a Dutch priest who also questioned the Catholic Church.